# Curriculum Sample Selections

Children, youth, and Bible institute instruction

This packet presents complete instructional selections from four curricula I developed. The samples show guided Bible reading, age-appropriate explanation, comprehension questions, application, lesson objectives, and student work supported by an instructor edition.


**01** **Genesis to Revelation** Page 2

Complete Day 1 devotion, In the Beginning. Children's devotional manuscript dated October 2026 through October 2027.

**02** **PLANTED Youth Curriculum** Pages 3-6

Complete introduction, Rooted in the Word. Original PDF pages 1-4, November 7, 2025 black-and-white edition.

**03** **Principles from Proverbs** Pages 7-11

Complete Lesson 1, The Beginning of Wisdom: The Fear of the LORD and the Two Ways. Final teacher copy with answers in red.

**04** **God's Words Preserved** Pages 12-17

Complete Lesson 1, Revelation and the Giving of God's Words. Version 6 student workbook (pages 12-14) and instructor copy (pages 15-17).


Source wording, questions, tables, and answer formatting are retained. Word-document selections have been repaginated; the PLANTED introduction uses the original PDF pages. Each selection is labeled by its source and edition.

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## Day 1 | Thursday, October 1, 2026 | In the Beginning

**Read aloud** Genesis 1:1-3

**KJV KEY PASSAGE | Genesis 1:1-3**

> 1 In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth.
> 2 And the earth was without form, and void; and darkness was upon the face of the deep. And the Spirit of God moved upon the face of the waters.
> 3 And God said, Let there be light: and there was light.

**ALSO READ PSALM 90:2**

> 2 Before the mountains were brought forth, or ever thou hadst formed the earth and the world, even from everlasting to everlasting, thou art God.

**Talk about the story** God was already there before He made the world. He has always been God (Psalm 90:2). The earth was dark. God spoke, and light appeared.

**CHECK UNDERSTANDING**

**1. Who was there in the beginning?** *Answer: God.*

**2. Was anyone there before God?** *Answer: No. God has always existed.*

**3. Was the earth light or dark at first?** *Answer: Dark.*

**4. What did God say?** *Answer: Let there be light.*

**5. What happened when He said it?** *Answer: There was light.*

**In your day** Think about waking in a dark room. How do you make it light? You need a lamp or switch. God made light just by speaking.

**Pray together** God, thank You for making light and our world. Amen.

**Memory verse** Genesis 1:1 — An adult says a short phrase; the child echoes it. Add the next phrase when ready.

# Introduction — Rooted in the Word

**Big Idea:**

A tree only grows strong when its roots go deep. Your life will only stand firm when it's rooted in God's Word. When you plant yourself close to the Bible, you'll grow, thrive, and bear fruit that lasts and so will this ministry and this church.

**Key Verse:**

"And he shall be like a tree planted by the rivers of water, that bringeth forth his fruit in his season; his leaf also shall not wither; and whatsoever he doeth shall prosper." — Psalm 1:3

## 1. Planted by the Rivers

"Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the ungodly, nor standeth in the way of sinners, nor sitteth in the seat of the scornful." — Psalm 1:1

The world offers its own advice, opinions, and voices, but the one who is blessed learns to say *no* to ungodly influence. The key to spiritual strength

is choosing where you plant yourself. If your roots are in God's Word, you'll draw from His strength every day.- Prov. 13:20; 1 Cor. 15:33

Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the _____.

## 2. Delighting in God's Word

"But his delight is in the law of the Lord; and in his law doth he meditate day and night." — Psalm 1:2

To be planted means to *delight* in God's Word, not reading out of duty, but because you love it. God's Word refreshes us, gives us wisdom, and keeps our hearts clean. The more time you spend in the Bible, the stronger your roots grow.- Psa. 119:97; Jer. 15:16; Job 23:12

His delight is in the _____ of the Lord.

## 3. Deep Roots Bring Stability

"And he shall be like a tree planted by the rivers of water." — Psalm 1:3a

When storms come, and they will, a tree with deep roots doesn't fall. In the same way, when your life is grounded in God's Word, you won't be easily shaken by temptation, trials, or pressure. Your strength is not in you, it's in where you're planted.- Col. 2:6-7

He shall be like a tree _____ by the rivers of water.

## 4. Fruit That Lasts

"That bringeth forth his fruit in his season." — Psalm 1:3b

A healthy tree produces fruit, not because it tries harder, but because it's alive and nourished. When your life is rooted in God's Word, the fruit of the Spirit, love, joy, peace, longsuffering, and more, will show in your words and actions.- John 15:5,8

When I am rooted in God's Word, I will bring forth _____ in my season.

## Direct Application




- **Plant Yourself:** Make God's Word your foundation. Read it daily, even if only a few verses.
- **Stay Near the Water:** Don't pull away from church, prayer, and godly friends, they keep you nourished.
- **Grow Steadily:** Growth takes time; don't rush it—stay faithful.
- **Bear Fruit:** Let others see Jesus Christ through your life and choices.

If I stay planted by God's Word, my life will _____ and prosper.

**Reflection Question:**

What kind of "soil" are your roots in right now? God's Word or the world's influence? What can you change this week to stay planted near Him?

**Prayer:**

"Lord, help me to root my life deeply in Your Word. Keep me close to You, growing stronger each day, and help me bear fruit that brings You glory."

**Memory Verse**: Psalm 1:3

# Lesson 1 — The Beginning of Wisdom: The Fear of the LORD and the Two Ways

**Lesson Overview:** Solomon wrote Proverbs so that young people would receive wisdom, instruction, and discretion. The book begins with its foundation, the fear of the LORD, and then sets two paths before every young person: the way of wisdom and the way of folly. It also introduces the kinds of people who walk those paths: the wise, the simple, the fool, and the scorner.

**MAIN PASSAGES:** Proverbs 1:1–33; 2:1–22; 3:1–18; 4:10–27; 9:10

**KEY VERSE | Proverbs 1:7 —** *The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge: but fools despise wisdom and instruction.*

**READ:** Proverbs 1:1–33; 2:1–22; 3:1–18; 4:10–27; 9:1–18; 1 Kings 3:5–14; 4:29–34; Psalm 111:10; Ecclesiastes 12:13; James 1:5; 3:13–18.

### Wisdom from Proverbs

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Why Proverbs was written | Proverbs 1:4 — ***"To give subtilty to the simple, to the young man knowledge and discretion"*** |
| Where wisdom begins | Proverbs 9:10 — ***"The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom"*** |
| Where wisdom comes from | Proverbs 2:6 — ***"For the LORD giveth wisdom: out of his mouth cometh knowledge and understanding."*** |
| What wisdom is worth | Proverbs 3:15 — ***"She is more precious than rubies"*** |
| The path of the just | Proverbs 4:18 — ***"But the path of the just is as the shining light, that shineth more and more unto the perfect day."*** |

| Principle | Proverb |
|---|---|
| The way of the wicked | Proverbs 4:19 — ***"The way of the wicked is as darkness: they know not at what they stumble"*** |

## 1. Why God Gave Us Proverbs

God gave Solomon ***"wisdom and understanding exceeding much, and largeness of heart"***. Solomon spoke three thousand proverbs (1 Kings 4:32), and God preserved the ones He wanted us to have in this book. Proverbs states its own purpose in its first verses: to know wisdom and instruction, to receive the instruction of wisdom, justice, judgment, and equity, and ***"to the young man knowledge and discretion"***.

Proverbs is written as a father speaking to his son. Over and over the book says, "My **son**" (Proverbs 1:8; 2:1; 3:1; 4:1). That makes it one of the most direct books in the Bible for young people. It does not give wisdom for some distant future; it gives wisdom for the decisions a young person faces now: what to listen to, who to follow, how to speak, how to work, and what to do with desire, money, and time.

### Key Words in Proverbs 1:2–5

| Word | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Wisdom | Seeing life from God's point of view and living skillfully by it |
| Instruction | Teaching that corrects and disciplines |
| Understanding | Discerning the difference between right and wrong, true and false |
| Subtilty | Shrewdness; the ability to see through deception (Proverbs 1:4) |
| Discretion | Careful judgment that thinks before acting (Proverbs 2:11) |
| Learning | Continued growth, even for the wise (Proverbs 1:5) |

## 2. The Fear of the LORD

Everything in Proverbs rests on one foundation: ***"The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge: but fools despise wisdom and instruction"***. The fear of the LORD is not terror that runs from God; it is **reverence** that takes God seriously. It means living with the awareness that God sees, God speaks, and God will judge. A person may have a high IQ and a full education, but without the fear of the LORD he has not even begun to be wise.

Proverbs shows that the fear of the LORD shapes the whole of life. It turns a person away from evil, lengthens life, gives confidence, and becomes a fountain of life.

### What the Fear of the LORD Does

| Result | Proverb |
|---|---|
| Hates evil | Proverbs 8:13 — ***"The fear of the LORD is to hate evil"*** |
| Departs from evil | Proverbs 16:6 — ***"by the fear of the LORD men depart from evil"*** |
| Gives confidence | Proverbs 14:26 — ***"In the fear of the LORD is strong confidence"*** |
| Is a fountain of life | Proverbs 14:27 — ***"The fear of the LORD is a fountain of life, to depart from the snares of death"*** |
| Is better than riches | Proverbs 15:16 — ***"Better is little with the fear of the LORD than great treasure and trouble therewith."*** |
| Brings honour | Proverbs 22:4 — ***"By humility and the fear of the LORD are riches, and honour, and life."*** |

> **Proverbs 3:5–6 —** *Trust in the LORD with all thine heart; and lean not unto thine own understanding. In all thy ways acknowledge him, and he shall direct thy paths.*

## 3. Two Ways and the People Who Walk Them

Proverbs presents life as a road with **two** directions. Wisdom calls in the streets and invites the simple to turn (Proverbs 1:20–23), while sinners entice the young man to join them (Proverbs 1:10–14). Chapter 9 pictures two women, Wisdom and Folly, each inviting the passerby into her house. Wisdom's house leads to life; of Folly's guests Solomon says, ***"he knoweth not that the dead are there"***.

Proverbs also describes the kinds of people found on these two roads. Learning to recognize them helps a young person see where he is and where he is headed.

### The People of Proverbs

| Person | Description | Proverb |
|---|---|---|
| The wise | Hears, fears God, receives correction, and keeps growing | Proverbs 1:5; 9:9 |
| The simple | Naive and easily led; believes every word | Proverbs 14:15; 22:3 |
| The fool | Trusts his own heart and despises instruction | Proverbs 12:15; 28:26 |
| The scorner | Mocks correction and spreads contempt | Proverbs 9:7–8; 13:1 |
| The sluggard | Lazy, full of excuses, and always wanting | Proverbs 13:4; 26:13–16 |
| The prudent | Foresees danger and acts carefully | Proverbs 14:8; 22:3 |

The good news is that no one is locked on a path. Wisdom calls, ***"Turn you at my reproof"***, and promises, ***"those that seek me early shall find me"***.

## Check Your Understanding

1. According to Proverbs 1:1–6, why did God give the book of Proverbs?
2. What does it mean to fear the LORD, and why is it the beginning of wisdom?
3. List four results of the fear of the LORD from Proverbs.
4. Describe the two invitations in Proverbs 9 and where each one leads.
5. Name and describe four kinds of people found in Proverbs.

PART I: FAITH-BASED

# INSPIRATION: What God Did Once

## LESSON 1 Revelation and the Giving of God's Words

**KEY TEXTS:** Deut. 29:29; Ps. 19:1–6; Rom. 1:20; Heb. 1:1–2; 2 Tim. 3:16–17; 2 Pet. 1:21; Matt. 4:4

***OBJECTIVES:*** *(1) Distinguish general revelation, special revelation, and inspiration. (2) Explain from Scripture the meaning of verbal, plenary inspiration.*

### 1. Defining Revelation

a. Revelation is God's _____ of what was hidden, so that it may be seen for what it is. The Hebrew verb *galah* is rendered in the KJV *uncovered* (Gen. 9:21), *appeared* (Gen. 35:7), *discovered* (Exod. 20:26), *opened* (Num. 22:31), *published* (Esth. 8:13), and *disclose* (Isa. 26:21).

> **DEUTERONOMY 29:29**
> *The secret things belong unto the LORD our God: but those things which are revealed belong unto us and to our children for ever, that we may do all the words of this law.*

b. The first mention sets the principle: what God reveals belongs to His people and to their children *for ever*, and it is given in order to be obeyed.

### 2. General Revelation

a. _____ revelation is the knowledge of God given to all men through creation and conscience (Ps. 19:1–6; Rom. 1:20). It declares His existence, power, and glory, and it leaves men without excuse. Because both creation and the human mind are marred by sin (Gen. 3:17; Rom. 8:22), it cannot reveal the way of salvation.

### 3. Special Revelation

a. _____ revelation is God's direct disclosure of Himself and His will. He spoke *at sundry times and in divers manners*:

| Means | Example |
|---|---|
| Dreams | Joseph (Gen. 37:5–10) |
| Visions | Daniel (Dan. 8:1) |
| The Urim and Thummim | The high priest (Exod. 28:30) |
| An audible voice | Samuel (1 Sam. 3:10) |
| An animal | Balaam's ass (Num. 22:28) |
| Prophets and apostles | 2 Pet. 1:21; Eph. 3:5 |

> **HEBREWS 1:1–2**
> *1 God, who at sundry times and in divers manners spake in time past unto the fathers by the prophets, 2 Hath in these last days spoken unto us by his Son, whom he hath appointed heir of all things, by whom also he made the worlds;*

b. The crown of special revelation is the _____ (John 1:14; 14:9). Its written and completed form is the Scripture, which alone now carries God's revelation to every generation.

## 4. The Meaning of Inspiration

a. The Greek adjective in 2 Timothy 3:16, θεόπνευστος (*theopneustos*), means _____.[1] Inspiration identifies God as the source of Scripture; it describes the product He breathed out, not a heightened human insight.

> **2 TIMOTHY 3:16–17**
> *16 All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness: 17 That the man of God may be perfect, throughly furnished unto all good works.*

b. In Scripture the breath of God imparts life: man became a living soul (Gen. 2:7), dry bones lived (Ezek. 37:9–10), and *the inspiration of the Almighty giveth them understanding* (Job 32:8). The written Word carries the same divine life and authority.

> **2 PETER 1:21**
> *For the prophecy came not in old time by the will of man: but holy men of God spake as they were moved by the Holy Ghost.*

c. The prophets spoke as they were moved, or borne along, by the _____. Inspiration occurred once, when they first wrote; later copyists and translators were not inspired in this sense.

[1] Jasper James Ray, *God Wrote Only One Bible* (Junction City, OR: Eye Opener Publishers, 1955).

## 5. Inspiration Extends to the Words

a. David testified, *The Spirit of the LORD spake by me, and his word was in my tongue* (2 Sam. 23:2), and Christ built an argument on one word of Psalm 110:1 (Matt. 22:43–45).

b. Because man lives *by every word* of God (Matt. 4:4), inspiration is _____, reaching the words and their smallest marks (Matt. 5:18). Because *all scripture* is given by inspiration, it is _____. Scripture is therefore inerrant and infallible, for God cannot lie (Titus 1:2).

## 6. The Divine Order

| Term | Meaning | Key text |
|---|---|---|
| Revelation | God makes truth known | Deut. 29:29 |
| Inspiration | God gives that truth in written words | 2 Tim. 3:16 |
| Illumination | The Spirit enables the believer to understand it | 1 Cor. 2:12 |
| Preservation | God keeps His words intact | Ps. 12:6–7 |
| Propagation | God's people carry the words to the world | Matt. 28:19–20 |

a. A believer may affirm preservation without propagating the Word, but no one can propagate it with conviction unless he knows it has been _____ without error.

### REVIEW

Explain the difference between saying the Bible *contains* God's message and saying it *is* God's words. Which does Matthew 4:4 require?

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